



The OS X Dashboard can be quite useful

widget you last used also remains the active one even if you exit the Dashboard and return to it later. So if you're working on a long paper and need to do a lot calculations time and again, you just invoke the Dashboard each time and start typing directly into the calculator. You can also drag stuff from the Desktop onto the dashboard, such as text into the dictionary widget to know its meaning, or any image onto the very handy ImageShack widget, which uploads the image to ImageShack and copies the code to the clipboard. So you simply drag an image onto it and paste the code wherever you want. If you drag a widget out of the shelf and exit the Dashboard, the widget itself floats on top of the Desktop. So you could drag the Stickies widget out of the Dashboard, and it will stay in view at all times, reminding you to take your puppy for a walk.

At the time of this writing, there are around 3,000 free widgets on Apple's download site. Within a span of two years, the sheer convenience of creating widgets has resulted in there being widgets for nearly everything the Dashboard is capable of doing. From blogging to webcams and networking to music, it's difficult to imagine that a user would need a widget that is not already there